

Improving access to imported food safety requirements

Imported food safety requirements are now included in the [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#).

See more about the [Inclusion of food safety requirements in BICON](#).

All biosecurity requirements must be met before [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#) requirements apply.

Check our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) for biosecurity import conditions.

We classify imported food that presents a potential medium or high risk to public health as [risk food](#). All risk food is listed in the [Imported Food Control Order 2019](#).

Raw milk cheese is classified as risk food

Raw milk cheese is cheese that has not undergone a heat treatment step during production. Heat treatment includes:

- [pasteurisation](#)
- [thermisation with additional measures](#)
- [high temperature curd cook with additional measures](#).

Only raw milk cheese that is covered by a [recognised foreign government certificate](#) can be imported. See [current certification arrangements](#).

Exclusions

Food from [New Zealand](#).

Current certification arrangements

France – Roquefort cheese and Ossau Iraty

You can import raw milk cheeses Roquefort and Ossau Iraty from France into Australia with this certificate.

Type of information	To include
National competent authority:	Ministère de l'Agriculture et de l'Alimentation
Recognised certificate title:	Health Certificate for the Export of Raw milk Cheese (Roquefort or Ossau Iraty) from France to Australia
ICS document code:	SCER

United Kingdom – 12 kinds of raw milk cheese

You can import these raw milk cheeses from the United Kingdom into Australia with this certificate.

- Appleby's Cheshire
- Appleby's Double Gloucester
- Hafod
- Isle of Mull
- Keen's Cheddar
- Kirkham's Lancashire
- Lincolnshire Poacher
- Montgomery's Cheddar
- Sparkenhoe Red Leicester
- St Andrew's Anster
- St Andrew's Cheddar
- Westcombe Cheddar

Type of information	To include
National competent authority:	Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland
Recognised certificate title:	Export of Raw Milk Cheese to Australia Health Certificate (includes Supplementary Certificate: Export of Raw Milk Cheese from the United Kingdom to Australia)
ICS document code:	RMCHCUK

Declaring certificates

When lodging a [Full Import Declaration \(FID\)](#), use the correct ICS document code and certificate number for the food.

Inspection and testing

We refer consignments of raw milk cheese for analytical testing at the rate of 5%.

During inspection, we will also conduct a visual and label assessment.

Table 1 shows the tests that will be applied and permitted results.

Table 1, Test applied and permitted result

Test applied	Permitted result
Salmonella	n=5, c=0, m=not detected in 25 g

Listeria monocytogenes

Ready-to-eat food which does not support the growth of *Listeria monocytogenes*

$n=5, c=0, m=100$ cfu/g

n = the number of samples to be analysed from a lot of food.

c = the maximum number of sample units that can be greater than 'm'.

m = the acceptable microbiological level in a sample unit.

Food safety risks

Food Standards Australia New Zealand (FSANZ) has given us [advice about the risk of raw milk cheese](#). This food presents a potential medium or high risk to public health for the pathogenic microorganisms:

- *Salmonella* spp.
- Shiga toxin producing *Escherichia coli*
- *Brucella* spp.
- *Mycobacterium bovis*.

To make sure there are food safety controls in place to manage these hazards, imports must be covered by a recognised [foreign government certificate](#). We verify these controls are effective by conducting analytical testing. See [current arrangements](#).

Glossary

Pasteurisation

Milk or dairy products used to make cheese or cheese products are pasteurised by:

- heating to at least 72° C and retaining at this temperature for no less than 15 seconds
- heating, using any other time and temperature combination of equal or greater lethal effect on any pathogenic microorganisms in the milk or dairy product
- using any other process that provides an equal or greater lethal effect on any pathogenic microorganisms.

Thermisation with additional measures

Milk used to make cheese or cheese products has been processed by being held at a temperature of at least 64.5°C for at least 16 seconds. The cheese or cheese product is stored at a temperature of no less than 7°C for at least 90 days from the date of processing.

High temperature curd cook with additional measures

Milk or dairy products used to make cheese or cheese products have been processed so the:

- curd is heated to at least 48°C
- cheese or cheese product has a moisture content of less than 39%, after being stored no less than 10°C for at least 120 days from the date of processing.

Version history

Date	Reference number	Amendment details
21/07/2022	RMC 07-2022	Updated with details of new recognised foreign government certificate for 12 kinds of raw milk cheese that can be exported under a new arrangement with the United Kingdom.
04/08/2021	RMC 08-2021	Updated with title of new recognised foreign government certificate for Roquefort and Ossau Iraty.
10/07/2018	RMC 07-2018	Updated to reflect the introduction of a mandatory IFIS Importer declaration for cheese made from unpasteurised milk.
9/05/2016	RMC 05-2016	New risk food

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/type/raw-milk-cheese>